Before you begin

Your habit: my diary and my life story

Keeping a diary

Buy a notebook or journal that you keep just for this programme. Start writing in it today, every day until your cohort begins, and keep going through the 28 days. You don't need to change anything yet: just notice, and write it down. Nobody else needs to read it.

Each time the habit shows up, write down:

- The time, and where you are.
- Whether you are alone, or who you are with.
- What you were doing just before.
- How you felt just before.
- How strong the urge was, from 0 to 5.

At the end of each day, write a few lines:

- What did I notice about my habit today?
- What made it easier? What made it harder?
- What emotions sat underneath it today?
- One thing I noticed about myself today.

My life story

Take your time with these. Write in your journal over a few days, as much or as little as feels right. There are no right answers: just be honest with yourself.

1. When did this habit first start? How old were you, and what was happening in your life at that time?

2. How has it changed over the years: times it was stronger, weaker, or stopped?

3. What is the habit a replacement for? What does it give you that you don't get another way?

4. Which emotions most often lead you to it?

5. What did you learn about this growing up?

6. What have you tried before, and what did you learn from it?

7. What does it cost you?

8. What has brought you to this group, now?

9. Who are you becoming? Describe a day in your life as that person.